

Seawall height in North Bay Village

The elevation your city requires, the datum it is measured in, and the section of code that says so.

NORTH BAY VILLAGE • MIAMI-DADE COUNTY

5.94

ft NAVD88 (7.50 ft NGVD29); design to allow future raise to 8.44 ft NAVD88

ULDC Sec. 8.16(B) requires shoreline properties being developed, redeveloped or substantially improved to meet the Village Seawall Design Criteria memo, adopted into the code as Appendix A. That memo sets a minimum seawall elevation of 5.94 ft NAVD88. Walls must also be designed so the cap can be raised 2.5 ft later, to 8.44 ft NAVD88.

The detail

TRIGGER	Development, redevelopment or substantial improvement of shoreline property, including new or expanded docks, piers, boat lifts - ULDC Sec. 8.16(B)
STANDARD	Seawall Design Criteria Project Memorandum (Moffatt & Nichol, Oct 19, 2020), incorporated as Appendix A - Sec. 8.16(B)
MINIMUM	Suggested minimum seawall elevation 5.94 ft NAVD (7.50 ft NGVD) - Appendix A memo (attached to Ord. No. 2021-006)
ADAPTABILITY	Design must allow raising the cap an additional 2.5 ft to 8.44 ft NAVD (10.0 ft NGVD) without redesign - Appendix A memo

Where this comes from: North Bay Village ULDC Sec. 8.16(B) and Appendix A (Seawall Design Criteria memo, Ord. No. 2021-006)

Verified: 2026-10. Rules change — check the date above against today.

Before you call a contractor

1

Know your datum

A height means nothing without the datum it is measured from. NAVD88 and MLW are different reference points and the same wall gives different numbers in each. Ask which one any quoted elevation refers to.

2

Get the existing elevation surveyed

You cannot tell whether a wall meets the requirement by looking at it. A surveyor shooting the top of the cap settles it in an hour.

3

Ask what triggers the requirement

Most cities only apply the minimum to new walls or to substantial repair. What counts as substantial is defined differently in each city, and it is usually a percentage of length or of cost.

4

Ask about building higher now

Several cities require a wall built below the final figure to be engineered so it can be raised later. Doing it once is cheaper than doing it twice.